

Rydeshare

AI Project Manager — Operator's Manual

Commercial-plumbing tenant-improvement (TI) · NorCal union crews

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Rydeshare is a terminal chat app that acts as your project manager's brain. You tell it about a plumbing TI job; it builds the plan, tracks every stage, tells you the single next action, and asks you for whatever it's missing. The money math (labor, wages, bid) is done by deterministic, unit-tested code — not guessed by the AI — so the numbers are reproducible. Everything is stored as plain JSON files on your machine.

COMPLIANCE — READ THIS. Every wage rate shipped with the tool is an unverified placeholder. Confirm against the current CA DIR determination (dir.ca.gov/oprl) and the applicable UA-local CBA before any bid, payroll, or contract use. This tool assists a qualified PM — it does not replace certified-payroll review, apprentice-ratio compliance, or licensed/code judgment.

Getting started

1. One-time setup

You need Node.js 22 or newer and an Anthropic API key (console.anthropic.com !' API Keys). The key lives only in your local .env file, which is gitignored and never committed.

```
cp .env.example .env      # paste your ANTHROPIC_API_KEY into .env
npm install
```

2. See it work in 60 seconds (no API key)

Before you wire up a key, watch the whole job play out. It drives the real engine and writes to a throwaway temp dir, so your real jobs are never touched.

```
npm run demo              # press Enter to step through each stage
npm run demo -- --auto    # hands-off – plays straight through
```

3. Start the app for real

```
npm run dev               # starts the chat REPL; type a message or a /command
```

Quit any time with /exit (or Ctrl-C).

Two ways to drive it

Slash commands are shortcuts; you can also just talk in plain English and the brain picks the right tool.

- /new "<name>" region=<SF|East Bay|North Bay|Sacramento|San Jose> — create a job
- /open <projectId> — reopen a saved job and get its next action
- /ingest <path-to-xlsx> — import a FastPipe export into the active job
- /status or /next — show the deterministic NEXT ACTION + OPEN QUESTIONS
- /briefing — what's on my plate: next action, tasks, emails, RFIs, inspections
- /tasks — list the job's to-dos (overdue first) · /email — logged emails
- /projects — list saved jobs · /help — banner · /exit — quit

Tasks, email & the daily briefing

Beyond estimating and bidding, the tool runs the job day-to-day:

- TASKS — a real action list (owner, due date, priority, status), separate from the install schedule. Overdue items surface first. Just tell the brain what you need to do, or who owns it.
- EMAIL (draft + track, never auto-sends) — it composes RFI, submittal, bid-proposal, change-order, schedule and procurement emails from the job's own data and logs them. You send by copy/paste, then it tracks 'awaiting reply'. Log incoming mail to keep correspondence in one place.
- DAILY BRIEFING — one snapshot of the whole job: stage + next action, open/overdue tasks, emails awaiting reply, open RFIs/submittals, and upcoming inspections.

Also tracked: RFIs, submittals, change orders, inspections, procurement, the install schedule, and a certified-

payroll preview — all shown in the step-by-step demo on the following pages.

The job lifecycle (stages)

A job moves through these stages. The tool will not let you skip ahead while required info is still missing — answer the open questions and it advances.

- Lease / Scope Review !' Estimate & Takeoff (FastPipe) !' Bid / Proposal
- Contract / Buyout !' Submittals & RFIs !' Schedule & Manpower
- Procurement !' Install & Inspections !' Certified Payroll
- Change Orders !' Closeout

Wages — the part that matters most

- Wages are seeded per UA local (38, 342, 393, 447) and every rate is flagged `verify=true` — do not trust the number yet.
- To confirm a rate, just tell the brain: "Confirmed journeyman base is \$95/hr per the Local 342 CBA." That clears the flag and records who/when.
- Any bid computed while unverified rates are in play is stamped UNVERIFIED — your guardrail against sending a number to a customer too early.

Troubleshooting

- WARNING: ANTHROPIC_API_KEY is not set !' copy `.env.example` to `.env` and paste your key.
- Unknown region "... " !' use exactly: SF, East Bay, North Bay, Sacramento, or San Jose.
- Won't advance a stage !' there are still OPEN QUESTIONS; run `/status` and answer them.
- A bid still says UNVERIFIED !' at least one wage rate is still a placeholder.
- Node version error !' you need Node 22+ (check with `node --version`).

The guided demo, step by step

These are live screenshots captured from `npm run demo -- --auto`. Every number is produced by the real engine — no API key, throwaway data dir.

Step 1 — Create the job

```
%$ STEP 1/18 - Create the job

Pick a region; it resolves the UA local and seeds placeholder wages.
cmd > /new "Acme Tower 12th-floor TI" region=East Bay
!' Created. UA Loca342 (East Bay), wage table seeded (all unverified).

[Acme Tower 12th-floor TI · Lease / Scope Review]
NEXT ACTION: Lease / Scope Review: Confirm the job basics: client/GC, region (drives the UA
local), jurisdiction, whether this is public works, and a scope summary. (resolve the blocking
items below to proceed)
OPEN QUESTIONS:
  • Is this a public works job (> $1,000 of public funds)? If so, prevailing wage + weekly
  certified payroll + apprentice ratios apply.
```

Step 2 — Ask what it needs

```
%$ STEP 2/18 - Ask what it needs

The NEXT ACTION + OPEN QUESTIONS are computed by code, not guessed.
cmd > /status

[Acme Tower 12th-floor TI · Lease / Scope Review]
NEXT ACTION: Lease / Scope Review: Confirm the job basics: client/GC, region (drives the UA
local), jurisdiction, whether this is public works, and a scope summary. (resolve the blocking
items below to proceed)
OPEN QUESTIONS:
  • Is this a public works job (> $1,000 of public funds)? If so, prevailing wage + weekly
  certified payroll + apprentice ratios apply.
  !' It is blocking on the public-works question before it will move on.
```

Step 3 — Import the FastPipe estimate

```
%$ STEP 3/18 - Import the FastPipe estimate

It parses the export and reports any column it can't map.
cmd > /ingest samples/sample_fastpipe.xlsx
!5 line items · 338.5 labor hrs · $21,420.00 material.
& Unmapped column(s): Notes — confirm or add an alias.
```

Step 4 — Answer in plain English

%¶ STEP 4/18 – Answer in plain English

In the live app you just talk; the brain calls `update_project`.

`you > Public works yes. Crew is 1 foreman, 3 journeymen, 1 step-3 apprentice.`

`!'` Recorded public-works = yes, scope, and the 5-person crew.

Step 5 — Compute labor cost

%¶ STEP 5/18 – Compute labor cost

Estimate hours × blended loaded crew rate – deterministic code.

`you > What's the labor cost?`

`!338.5 hrs × $111.71/hr = $37,813.84`

`& Blend used UNVERIFIED placeholder wages – confirm before quoting.`

Step 6 — Compute the bid

%¶ STEP 6/18 – Compute the bid

Full waterfall with overhead & profit. Every input is echoed back.

`you > Use 15% overhead and 10% profit. Compute the bid.`

`% % Bid waterfall % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % %`

`%Labor (loaded) $37,813.84`

`%Labor + burden $37,813.84`

`%Material $21,420.00`

`%Tax $1,765.00`

`%Rentals $500.00`

`%Subtotal $61,498.84`

`%Contingency $0.00`

`%Overhead $9,224.83`

`%Profit $7,072.37`

`% % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % %`

`%TOTAL BID $77,796.04`

`% % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % %`

`& Labor uses UNVERIFIED placeholder wage rates (verify=true) – confirm against the current DIR determination / UA-local CBA before quoting.`

`!'` The UNVERIFIED stamp is your guardrail: don't send this number to a customer yet.

Step 7 — Confirm a CBA wage & re-run

%¶ STEP 7/18 – Confirm a CBA wage & re-run

Give it a real number; the verify flag clears, math updates.

you > Confirmed journeyman base is \$95/hr per the Local 342 CBA. Re-run the bid.

% % Bid waterfall %

%Labor (loaded) \$40,860.34

%Labor + burden \$40,860.34

%Material \$21,420.00

%Tax \$1,765.00

%Rentals \$500.00

%Subtotal \$64,545.34

%Contingency \$0.00

%Overhead \$9,681.80

%Profit \$7,422.71

% %

%TOTAL BID \$81,649.85

% %

& Labor uses UNVERIFIED placeholder wage rates (verify=true) – confirm against the current DIR determination / UA-local CBA before quoting.

' Journeyman row verifiedBid moved \$77,796.04 !\$81,649.85.

' Stage gatedata complete !' advanced Lease !' Estimate !' Bid !' Contract !' Submittals & RFIs.

Step 8 — Draft the proposal email

%¶ STEP 8/18 – Draft the proposal email

draft_email composes from job state and LOGS it – it never auto-sends.

you > Draft the proposal email to the GC.

% % email (draft) % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % % %

%To: Turner GC – J. Reyes

%Subject: [Acme Tower 12th-floor TI] Proposal – Plumbing TI

%

%Hi team,

%

%Thank you for the opportunity to bid the plumbing scope on Acme Tower 12th-floor TI.

%

%Our proposed price is \$81,649.85, covering the DWV, domestic water, gas, and fixture scope per the documents.

%

%Note: this number is being finalized pending confirmation of current prevailing-wage/CBA rates and is not yet for contract.

%...

% %

' Marked sent(you send by copy/paste; now tracked as awaiting reply).

Step 9 — Log an RFI + email it out

%¶ STEP 9/18 – Log an RFI + email it out

```
you > RFI: water-heater venting conflicts with HVAC at grid line C – confirm WH-2 flue routing.
```

%To: Architect – DLR

%Subject: [Acme Tower 12th-floor TI] RFI – Water heater venting routing

```
%Hi team,
```

```
%We need clarification before we can proceed on Acme Tower 12th-floor TI:
```

```
%RFI: Water heater venting routing
```

```
%WH-2 flue conflicts with HVAC duct at grid line C – confirm routing/clearance.
```

```
' RFI logged & email sent.
```

Step 10 — Log a submittal

%¶ STEP 10/18 – Log a submittal

Track fixtures/valves/backflow to approval before release.

```
you > Submittal: 22 40 00 plumbing fixtures + RPZ backflow cut sheets.
```

' Submittal pending approval.

Step 11 — Build the to-do list

%⏏ STEP 11/18 – Build the to-do list

```
you > Add my follow-ups.
```

!3 open · 1 overdue

[high] Confirm foreman & apprentice CBA base rates !' You (due 2026-06-15) **OVERDUE**

[high] Order 2" RPZ backflow (long lead) !' Procurement due 2026-06-24)

[normal] Walk grid line C with HVAC foreman !' Field (due 2026-06-20)

Step 12 — Generate the install schedule

```
%¶ STEP 12/18 – Generate the install schedule
Rough-in !' top-out !' trim sequence with durations & dependencies.
you > Build the schedule starting 2026-07-01.
!11 tasks · finish 2026-08-28
  • Underground / under-slab rough-in (2026-07-01 !' 2026-07-07)
  • Above-ground DWV rough-in (2026-07-07 !' 2026-07-15)
  • Domestic water rough-in (2026-07-15 !' 2026-07-22)
```

Step 13 — Record procurement

```
%¶ STEP 13/18 – Record procurement
Long-lead material tracked against need-by dates.
you > Procurement: 2" RPZ backflow, Ferguson, quoted, need by 2026-07-10.
' Logged (quoted).
```

Step 14 — Schedule an inspection

```
%¶ STEP 14/18 – Schedule an inspection
Inspections gate the phases: rough-in before cover, then top-out, final.
you > Schedule the rough-in inspection for 2026-07-08.
' Rough-in inspection scheduled.
```

Step 15 — Certified-payroll preview

```
%¶ STEP 15/18 – Certified-payroll preview
Public-works weekly gross at base rate + apprentice-ratio check (preview only).
you > Log week-ending 2026-07-10 hours and show the certified-payroll preview.
!200 hrs · gross $16,680.00
' apprentice ratio OKApprentice hours (40) within 1:1 of journeyman hours (120))
& Gross computed from UNVERIFIED placeholder wage rates – confirm prevailing-wage
determination before submitting CPRs.
& PREVIEW ONLY – not a DIR-compliant certified payroll report. XML/eMars export is a later
phase.
```

Step 16 — Log a change order

```
%¶ STEP 16/18 – Log a change order
Priced COs are tracked and (phase 2) flow into contract value.
you > CO: add 2 mop sinks in the level-12 break rooms, +$4,200.
' CO logged (pending).
```


Step 17 — Log a reply & close a task

%¶ STEP 17/18 – Log a reply & close a task

Inbound mail can auto-clear the awaiting-reply flag; tasks get marked done.
you > Architect replied on the venting RFI; mark the grid-line-C walk done.
' Reply logged (RFI email no longer awaiting); 1 task completed.

Step 18 — Daily briefing

%¶ STEP 18/18 – Daily briefing

One snapshot of the entire job – the 'what's on my plate' command.

cmd > /briefing

%P%P%P Acme Tower 12th-floor TI · Install & Inspections %P%P%P

NEXT ACTION: Install & Inspections is unblocked – confirm with the user, then advance_stage to "Certified Payroll".

TASKS: 2 open, 1 overdue

[high] Confirm foreman & apprentice CBA base rates !' Yo(du 2026-06-15) OVERDUE

[high] Order 2" RPZ backflow (long lead) !' Procuremen(du 2026-06-24)

EMAIL: 0 draft, 1 awaiting reply

OPEN: RFIs 1 · submittals 1 · inspections 1

That's the whole loop. estimate !' bid !' RFIs/submittals !' email !' tasks !' schedule !' procurement !' inspections !' payroll !' change orders !' briefing.

Run it for real with your own jobs: npm run dev · Full guide: MANUAL.md

That's the loop: ingest !' plan !' ask !' compute !' verify !' advance. Run it for real with your own jobs via npm run dev. The editable source of this manual is MANUAL.md in the repo.